

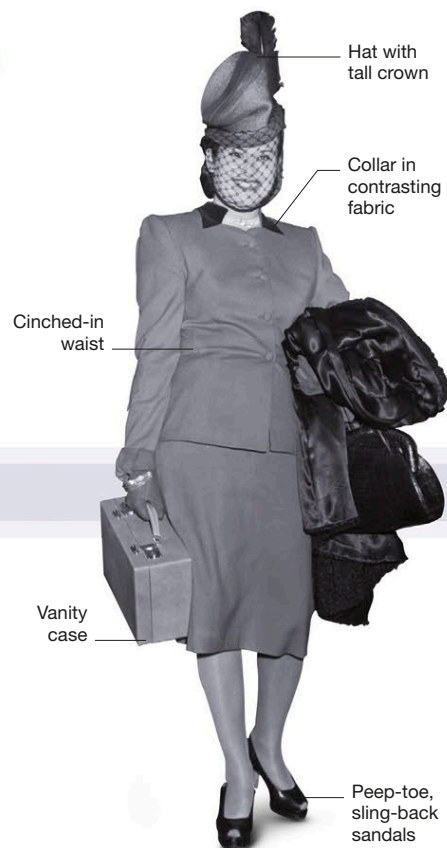


**Charles James** The complex seams of this herringbone wool suit by US-based Charles James emphasize the outfit's silhouette and accentuate the nipped-in waist by approaching it from the sleeves. The central button draws further attention to the waistline.



1945

**Balenciaga** The straight shoulders and boxy silhouette seen in England in the war years were not so prominent in Paris. The narrow waist and the full upper sleeves of Balenciaga's wool coat, plus a large hat, introduce drama.



**Wide shoulders** Having made the first transcontinental rail journey from Los Angeles to New York, this passenger disembarks in style in a wide-shouldered jacket with a narrow waist, slim skirt, and a spotted veil.

## THEATRE DE LA MODE



In 1945, French couturiers staged what *Harpers Bazaar* called "a luxurious puppet show" to collect funds for war survivors and to revive the French fashion industry. Each house donated up to five outfits, as well as accessories, to dress more than 170 fashion dolls. After a debut in Paris in March 1945, shows followed in London, Leeds, Copenhagen, Stockholm, and Vienna before the mannequins arrived in New York in May 1946, now clad in the latest Spring/Summer collection. While they had been travelling a fashion revolution had occurred.



**Balmain** The first post-war Paris shows caused both indignation and admiration. Luxuriously full skirts, as seen in Pierre Balmain's coat and candy-striped dress, stood in contrast to the dire circumstances in which many Parisians still lived.